

Topic-1: Foot printing - conducting competitive Intelligence

Footprinting is the first phase of ethical hacking and reconnaissance. It is the process of collecting publicly available information about a target organisation without directly interacting with its systems. Passive footprinting helps organisations understand their online presence while avoiding detection.

To identify the company's domain registration details, the WHOIS tool is used. It provides information such as the domain owner, registrar, name, registration date, expiration date, name servers, and contact details. This helps understand who owns the domain and how it is managed.

1. Domain Registration Details.

Tool: WHOIS

- ⇒ Finds domain over information
- ⇒ Shows registration details
- ⇒ Displays registration and expiry dates
- ⇒ Identifies name servers.

use in competitive intelligence:

- * understands domain ownership
- * Analyses infrastructure management
- * Tracks competitors domain changes

2. Employee email addresses.

Tool: the Harvester

- * collects public email addresses
- * Finds employee names
- * searches search engines and public sources

3. Technology stack:

Tool: Builtwith / Wappalizer

- * detects CMS webserver.
- * Finds programming language

Topic: 2. - DNS Zone Transfers:

Def:

A DNS Zone Transfer (AXFR) copies DNS records from a primary DNS server to a secondary DNS server

Verification command:

using dig.

dig AXFR example.com

@ns1.example.com

using host:

host -l example.com

ns1.example.com

Records Retrieved:

- * A records
- * MX records
- * NS records
- * CNAME records
- * TXT records
- * Internal hostnames
- * subdomains

Information Gained:

Internal Hosts:

- * Development servers
- * Backup servers
- * VPN servers

Topic - 3: Social Engineering - phishing Attack:

Type of Attack:

phishing Attack:

Fake email from IT department.

creates urgency.

- ⇒ Requests login credentials.
- ⇒ contains a malicious link.

Warning signs:

- ⇒ unknown or suspicious sender.
- ⇒ urgent language.
- ⇒ spelling or grammar mistakes
- ⇒ unusual link or attachment
- ⇒ Request for password or OTP.

Countermeasures:

Verify sender:

- ⇒ check the full email address.
- ⇒ confirm through official channels.

Avoid clicking links:

- ⇒ Hover over links before opening.
- ⇒ Type the official website manually.

Do Not Share Credentials:

- ⇒ Never enter passwords from email links.
- ⇒ Never share OTPs

Report the Email:

- ⇒ Inform the IT/security team.
- ⇒ Mark as phishing.